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Jesus Velez

Senior Art Director

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About me

I am a storyteller. I like to tell stories.
Toronto-based Art Director with a unique blend of technical expertise and artistic creativity, honed through years of experience as both a Front-End Developer and an Art Director. I've worked with diverse clients across industries such as Finance, Health Care, and Government. When I'm not working with clients, I create independent animated pieces that blend traditional analogue techniques with creative coding technologies.

Disclaimer: ***Orange*** is my favorite colour.

Selected Client List

A selected list of clients I have been able to work with, through the agency SAGE Renegade in Toronto, Canada. And other marketing agencies in Lima, Peru.

NOVARTIS

Pfizer

BAUSCH + LOMB

MEDISON

FERRING PHARMACEUTICALS

AstraZeneca

Scotiabank.

BBVA

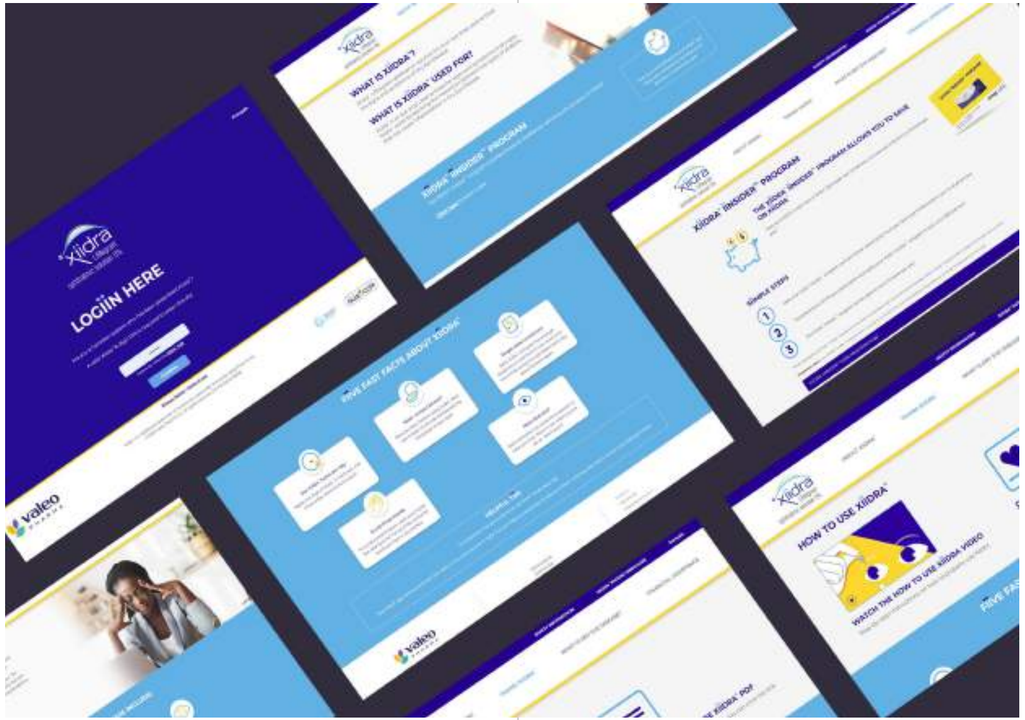
Web Design/ Development

Xiidra

Client: Bausch + Lomb.
Brand: Xiidra (xiidra.ca)
Project: Development of the website for patients who use Xiidra to treat the signs and symptoms of Dry Eye Disease.
Role: Designer, UI Animator and Front-end Developer.
Bilingual (English & French)
Live since 05/2023

xiidra.ca is an important resource for patients beign treated with Xiidra® (an ophthalmic solution). Patients can learn about Xiidra® and how to use the eye drop to treat the signs and symptoms of dry eyes. This website was designed in Figma and later developed mainly with html5, css and vanilla js.

Keywords: Web Design, Figma, Front-end Development, HTML, CSS, Javascript, LottieFiles, GSAP, Bootstrap.



Primary #215c6b
Secondary #52b4ab
Accent #f58221

H1 - Avenir Black
H2 - Avenir Black
p - Avenir Book

I builded a design system to use in the website. The whole website was re-designed (keeping the Brand Guidelines) as a new site focus on patients taking Xiidra.

Part of re-thinking the website was making animated icons for a dynamic experienced.

I coded the UI animations using JSON files and the Lottie web player to render.

Iconography

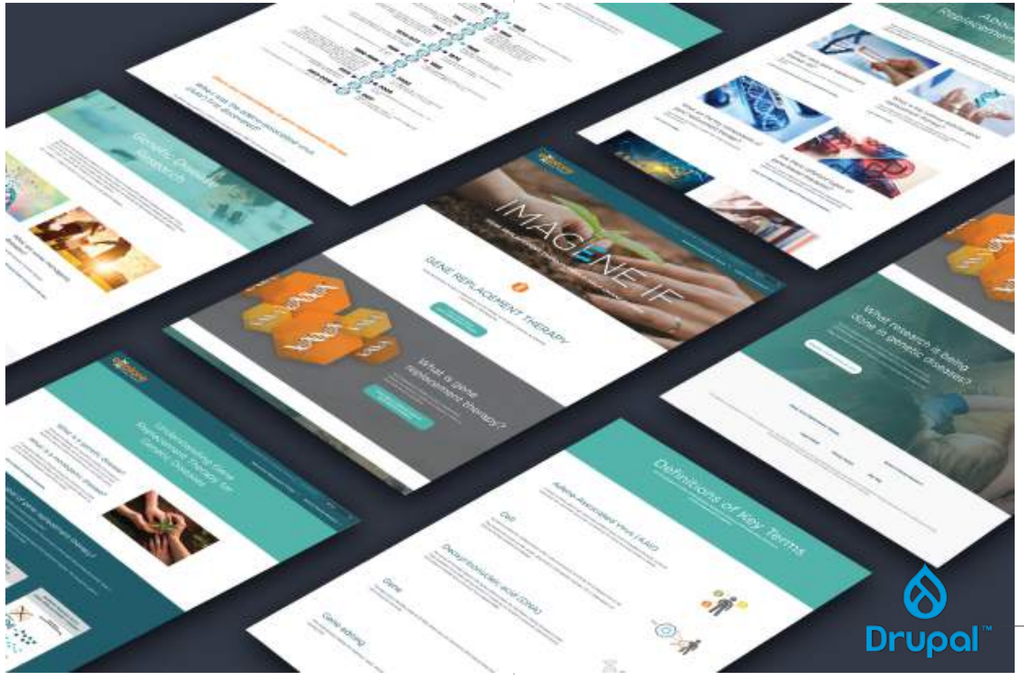
I developed the site mainly focused in the interactive functions using Vanilla JS. I also was responsible of the web responsiveness for desktop and mobile devices. Worked with Bootstrap and Media Queries in CSS.

Explore Gene Therapy

Client: Novartis.
Brand: Explore Gene Therapy.
Project: Development of the first website about gene therapy approved in Canada.
Role: Designer and Front-end Developer.
Bilingual (English & French)
Launched in 12/2020. Live until 12/2022.

exploregenetherapy.ca was build as an important resource that can be shared with caregivers and patients in Canada to help create awareness about the benefits of Genetic Therapies. The site was design in Figma and later developed in Drupal 9 as per client's request.

Keywords: Web Design, Figma, CMS, Front-end Development, Drupal 9, CSS, SEO.



Primary
#215c6b

Secondary
#52b4ab

Accent
#f58221

H1 - Gotham Rounded Bold
H2 - Gotham Rounded Medium
p - Gotham Rounded Book

I builded a design system to use in the website. Even though we kept the colour palette from the original brand, we were able to re-brand a few elements like the font and the hiarachy of the copy.

Call To Action

Learn more about gene replacement therapy

Lo-fi wireframe

Iconography

Responsive Design

I co-developed the website through the CMS "**Drupal 9**". This was aligned to the Novartis Global Marketing department for digital solutions.

Lima Philharmonic Orchestra

Client: Lima Philharmonic Orchestra (OFL)
Site: filarmonicadelima.com
Project: Design and development of the website aimed for informative and promotional purposes of the OFL
Role: Designer and Front-end Developer.
Live since 08/2024

filarmonicadelima.com is an important resource for music enthusiasts and event organizers, creating awareness around the artistry and cultural impact of the Philharmonic Orchestra of Lima and their events and initiatives. This website was designed in Figma and later developed mainly with html5, css and vanilla js.

Keywords: Web Design, Figma, UI Design, Front-end Development, HTML, CSS, Javascript, GSAP.

Primary #191919 | Secondary #F2EFE8 | Accent #F9CD00

H1 – Gilroy Bold

H2 - Garamond Regular

p – Gilroy Regular

I builded a design system to use in the website. The branding was an early proccess of the prototype, but at the start of the project there was a lack of visual identity to build up the website.

After further research and discussion, the concept for the website was inspired by the Russian avant-garde art movement from the early 1920s.

This aesthetic echoes the visual language of music and offers a dynamic composition that highlights what an orchestra represents.

Animation plays an important role to the landing page of the website. When the user hits the “play” button on top of one shape, the geometrical shapes become animated and move along with the introductory sound of the Beethoven’s Symphony 9, 2nd movement.

This was achieve using GSAP animation and vanilla Javascript.

Editorial Design

Depo-Medrol

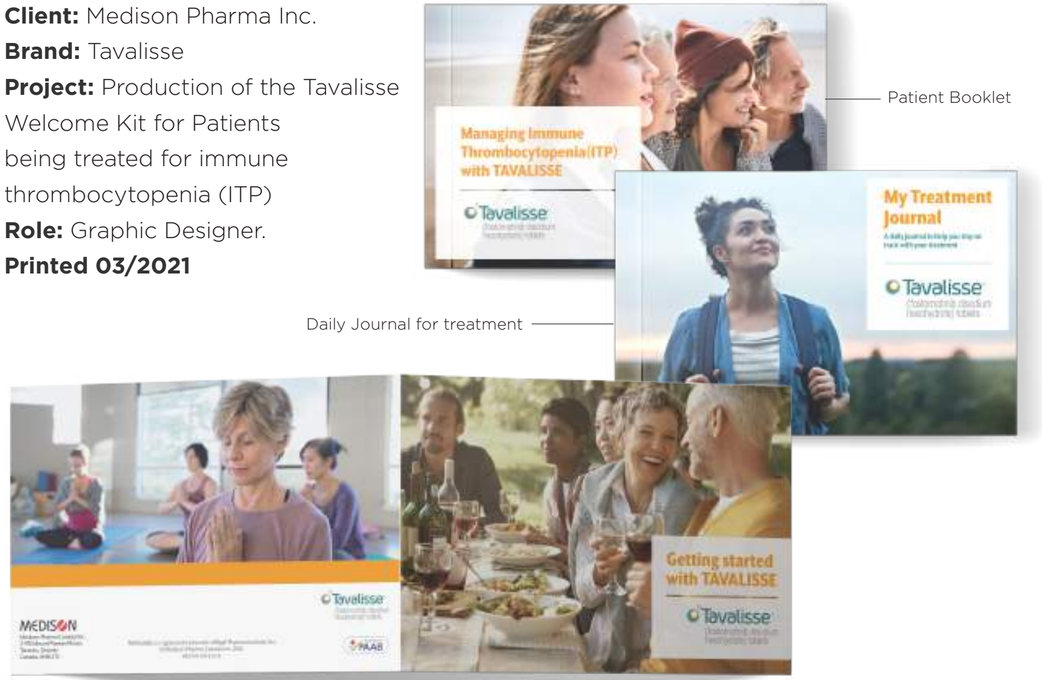
Client: Pfizer.
Brand: Depo-Medrol
Project: Series of Journal Ads to promote Depo-Medrol's over 50 years of experience.
Role: Graphic Designer.
Published 08/2021

Depo-Medrol is used to treat pain and swelling that occurs with arthritis and other joint disorders. These series of Journal Ads were produce to promote the 50 Years of Experience for the Brand among the medical community.

I worked under the lead of the Creative Director to illustrate 3 versions for the PR publishing.

Tavalisse

Client: Medison Pharma Inc.
Brand: Tavalisse
Project: Production of the Tavalisse Welcome Kit for Patients being treated for immune thrombocytopenia (ITP)
Role: Graphic Designer.
Printed 03/2021



Patient Booklet

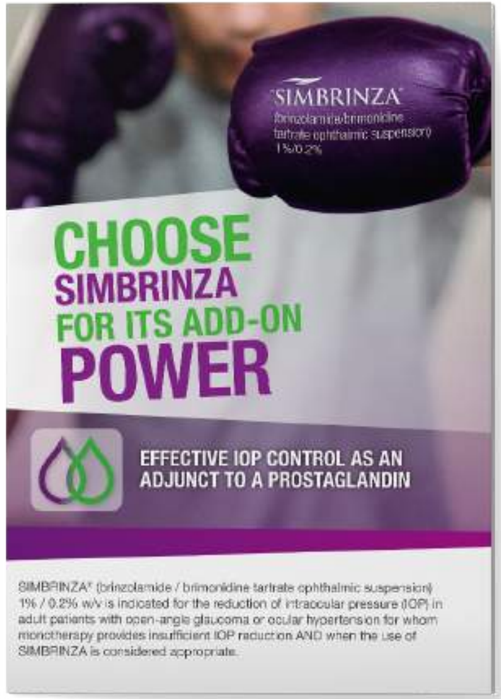
Daily Journal for treatment

Starter Kit Folder, with internal pockets to hold the other 2 pieces

Simbrinza

Client: Valeo Pharma Inc.
Brand: Simbrinza
Project: Design the Simbrinza Efficacy Leave Behind
Role: Graphic Designer.
Printed 06/2023

Simbrinza is used to treat High Eye Pressure in Open-Angle Glaucoma. This Efficacy Leave Behind is intended to be used by Valeo's pharmaceutical reps to highlight Simbrinza's efficacy, safety and use to physicians.



Animation/ Motion Graphics

Xiidra - How to use

Client: Bausch + Lomb.
Brand: Xiidra
Project: Animated instructive video for the use of Xiidra
Role: Animator.
Released 01/2023

The HOW TO USE XIIDRA video was created for the patient website and other patient-focused digital platforms for Xiidra.

The instructional script came from the US manufacturer, but needed to be tailored by the agency's medical writers. Together with graphic designers and myself during the animation process, the video came to life with a friendly, easygoing tone to guide patients in using this ophthalmic solution for dry eye disease.

The video can be view under disclosure in the following link:
https://player.vimeo.com/video/891927823?

Behold The Ampelmann!

Project: This is a personal project made during the mentorship program I was awarded by the Toronto Arts Council.
Role: Animator.

Behold The Ampelmann! is a short experimental animated film based on a personal experience during a trip to Berlin. The film offers a non-narrative take on the city's atmosphere—its people, their pastimes, and how these coexist with a rich history of political conflict, aesthetics, and ideas.

The animation combines paper collage techniques with direct-to-film methods. It features 2D footage animated using a stop-motion camera setup, along with 16mm film altered through experimental, hands-on techniques directly on the celluloid.

The film is under development, but a video preview of the project can be seen in the following link:
https://player.vimeo.com/video/1029010679?

Animated Dance

Project: This is a personal project made during a Studio Immersion program I was selected by aLucine Film Festival .
Role: 3D Animator, Creative Coder.

Animated Dance is a WebXR project developed in collaboration with the Artificial Museum (based in Vienna), designed as an Augmented Reality experience combining 3D animation, sound design, and creative coding.

The project explores the concept of a “live performance” in animation. Featuring organic shapes with vibrant textures, the experience immerses viewers in a space where the visuals respond to a music track—performing an animated dance rendered in real time.

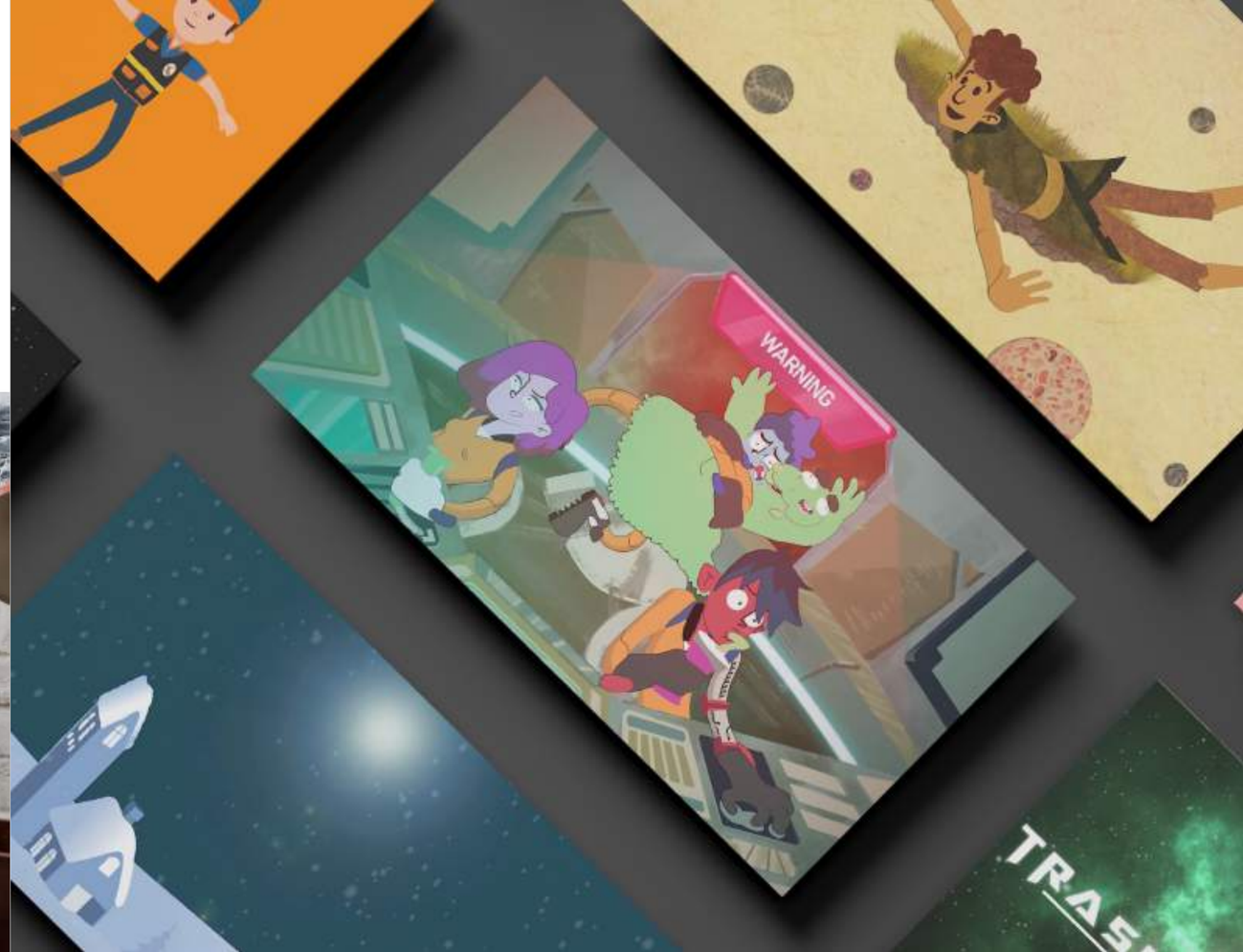
The piece is “exhibited” on the Philosopher’s Walk in downtown Toronto. Accessible through the Artificial Museum’s website, it uses geolocation to activate via an AR browser app on any smartphone.

A browser version of the project can be seen at the link below, giving a preview of the full AR experience.
https://artificialmuseum.com/na/ca/toronto/philosopherswalk/animateddance/#18/43.6683/-79.3957

Animation Reel

Project: A collection of multiple animated content developed in the past with a focus in 2D animation and motion grapchis.
Role: Animator.

The video can be view in the following link:
https://player.vimeo.com/video/280142856?



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